Phone and Wearables Data Donation in Mental Healthcare

We would like to invite you to donate information to a research database, as you are accessing services or have accessed services at the South London and Maudsley NHS Trust

- Before you decide whether to take part, it is important for you to understand why we are making the database and what joining it looks like.
- Please take time to read the information carefully. You can chat about it with your clinician, relatives or friends if you would like to.
- Joining the research database is completely optional. It is up to you to decide if you would like to take part. Your decision about taking part will not affect the care you receive.
- You can contact Luce Stewart if anything is unclear at this email address: CRIS.Administrator@slam.nhs.uk . Please mention in your email that you are asking about the data donation study.

What is the purpose of the study?

Research studies have found that collecting information from smartphones (mobile phones typically with touchscreen devices, internet and apps) and wearable devices (portable electronic gadgets designed to be worn on the body, such as smartwatches, Fitbits, fitness trackers and smart rings) can build a better picture of someone's health.

In this project, we would like to ask people using South London and Maudsley services, or people who have used South London and Maudsley services in the past, to donate information (data) from their wearable devices. The information they donate will be linked to their mental health record and both will be kept anonymised using the Maudsley's CRIS (Clinical Records Interactive

Search) platform. Keeping the information anonymised means that nobody will be able to identify you from the information.

Why are we doing the project?

Very large numbers of people now own a smartphone and increasing numbers of people also wear a smartwatch. These automatically collect information that may indicate levels of physical activity, social activity and sleep.

Being able to see patterns of exercise, sleep and heart rate may give a better idea of what happens in between appointments than relying on how someone feels at the time they are seen. However, this needs further development, ideally with large numbers of people whose wearable information has been linked to their health record.

Getting more information from phones or wearables between appointments might provide a fuller picture of health over time than something like a symptom diary, although this needs to be investigated. Information from these devices is clearly not perfect, but smartphones and/or wearable devices are becoming more advanced in their capability.

Why have I been chosen?

You have been invited to take part because you are aged 18 or over and accessing services at the South London and Maudsley NHS Trust currently or have accessed services previously.

Do I have to take part?

No, you do not have to take part. Taking part in the database is your decision, so you are free to say no.

If you do agree to take part, please keep a copy of this information [link to download] and follow the link at the bottom of the page to complete a consent form. You are free to withdraw from the study at any time after this point and without giving a reason.

The care that you receive will not be affected in any way if you decide you do not want to take part, or if you withdraw.

What happens if I decide to take part?

To donate your data, you will need to give consent after reading this information sheet – the link is at the end of this page. Giving consent means you are allowing us to download relevant data from your phone, store it securely in the South London and Maudsley NHS Trust, and link it to your health records.

We would recommend that you take some time to think over the information you have read before signing the consent form. You can talk about the consent form and process with your clinician, a relative or a friend if you wish to before signing.

On the online consent form, you will see a series of statements about what you are being asked to agree to if you take part in the study. You must click 'yes' for all these statements to join. You will then see another set of statements that are optional. You can click 'yes' or 'no' to these statements and still take part. Finally, you will be asked to sign the consent form by typing or drawing your signature.

After you have signed the online consent form, you will follow a link to our portal for the data donation.

The portal will guide you through the data donation process. You will be asked for some details about yourself, such as your hospital or NHS number and your email. We ask for the email address of all participants in case we need to contact you about any problems with the data linkage. When giving your email, you will have the option to tell us what you would like to be contacted about, such as newsletters or study results. If you would like to be contacted further, we will keep your email address in a separate location to your data.

You will also be asked what device you would like to donate your data from. The types of data you can donate (e.g. sleep, heart rate) will depend on what device you are donating from. We will only ask you to donate data which is relevant to your general health. We will not ask you to donate data which is not relevant, such as location tracking data stored on your device.

After the data is donated, you will have the chance to tell us what you thought about the process. At any time in the process, you can pause and contact the research team with any questions.

Who will have access to my data and how will it be used?

All of the information collected for the database will be de-identified. This means that the information we store will not include anything which would allow someone to identify you.

To begin with, the information you have provided will be stored at King's College London. The downloaded information from your device will be stored separately from the personal information that you have provided, so that it is not identifiable. Every few months, this information will be linked to your record at the South London and Maudsley NHS Trust. All information will move to the South London and Maudsley NHS Trust at that point and there will no longer be any information held at King's College London. The personal information that you provided will only be used to make sure that the link is correct and will then be destroyed. If you agreed to receive news about the study or to be contacted further, your email will be kept, but it will not be possible to link this to your record or the information you have donated.

We will not link any information for at least 2 weeks after it has been donated, so if you wish to withdraw from the study during that period, we can remove the information you have provided. Once the donated information has been linked to your clinical record at the South London and Maudsley NHS Trust, we will not be able to delete information we have about you, as it will have been anonymised.

To make sure people can't identify you, your name will be replaced with a code, and the information collected from the apps and wearable device will only be associated with this code. The people who analyse the information will not be able to identify you and will not be able to find out your name or contact details.

Where this information could identify you, such as immediately after you donate it, the information will be held securely with strict arrangements about who can access the information.

The Trust will be able to identify your data in future if you submitted a request to know what information is held about you (this is known as a Subject Access Request, or SAR).

The information will only be used for the purpose of health and care research, or to contact you if you opt in to receiving email updates or newsletters. It will not be used to make decisions about future services available to you, such as insurance.

What are the risks and benefits to taking part?

As we are collecting data already available from a device you already own, this process is very safe and unlikely to cause you any harm. We hope that improved symptom tracking and reporting will allow clinicians to better understand those who access support and improve their quality of life as a result.

What will happen to the results of the research?

The results of the database and data linkage will be published in scientific journals and presented at conferences. In any report or publication, you will not be identified personally. If you would like to find out about the research database findings, please tick the box on the consent form which gives us permission to stay in contact.

Who has reviewed the research?

The idea for this database has come from discussions between several researchers and has been developed in response to comments and suggestions from people with mental health lived experience.

What if there is a problem?

If you have any questions about the database or need support to take part, you can chat with our research team about this. Please contact:

Luce Stewart
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CRIS.Administrator@slam.nhs.uk